

Ciaran Finnegan

IT QA Engineering Manager

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AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Software Quality Assurance/Development management

Generative AI and AI Agents in software quality assurance

Data Analysis + Visualisation

Java Selenium/Selenide test automation

IT Project Portfolio management

Stakeholder management

Leading onshore, near shore and offshore teams

PROFESSIONAL

ISTQB : Advanced Level Test Manager - 2012

Professional Scrum Master 1 (PSM 1) - 2014

ACADEMIC

MSc. In Data Science – TU Dublin (1.1) 2024

H.Dip in Science in Data Analytics (1.1) – DBS 2020

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

As an ISTQB Manager, embracing AGILE techniques, I have built a test automation first strategy with hands-on experience of Java/Python Selenium test frameworks. I efficiently manage geographically dispersed test engineers for the successful release of financial crime product modules, across both on-premise and cloud platforms.

An MSc in Data Science has enabled me to research current AI software testing challenges, and to implement data visualisations (PowerBI) for stakeholder management.

I am a strong advocate for the productivity gains that AI can bring to the software testing industry in 2025 and beyond and wish to explore this further in new roles.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Company name – SymphonyAI (Dual roles)

Software Quality Assurance Manager January 2012 – Present

Dublin based Manager/Chapter Lead of the Product Quality Assurance team in the SymphonyAI Financial Services division.

I determine the overarching test strategy of the Product QA team across a portfolio of on-premise and SaaS product lines, which includes an ongoing and evolving AI driven QA automation technology roadmap.

The role involves;

- Spearheading a formal cross product test strategy, which has driven automated test coverage (Java Selenium/Selenide) for functional components into the 80%-95% range (from a near zero base in 2014).
- Ownership of a technical UI and API test automation roadmap for the Product QA team, reviewed quarterly in the QA Chapter, to ensure the application of continuous Generative AI and AI Agent led test automation process improvements in 2025/2026, which include:
    - Development of Python utilities (using VSC and Roo Code) to increase speed of test data generation and test case creation (Jira/Zephyr) by 40% in 2025.
    - Adoption by all test engineers of GitHub CoPilot Agent resulting in a 25% increase in the speed of new test automation creation in the last 12-month period.
    - Promoting innovation with new LLM models, evolving MCP Servers, and multi-agentic project structures for consistent, high-quality AI-led test automation output that will deliver on improved target metrics for 2026.
    - Additional Python application development to improve the generation and reporting of QA metrics via a PowerBI interface to stakeholder groups.
    - Research into technologies/libraries to include non-deterministic tests of LLM responses and AI Agent actions into our product verification cycles.

B.Sc in Computer Science (2.1) – DCU 1996

PERSONAL SKILLS

Committed

Forward thinking

Focused

CONTACT

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Driving license: Yes
Nationality: Irish

- Management of a 15+ person QA team (Ireland/Poland/India) responsible for the bi-annual/monthly release quality of the SymphonyAI Financial Crime product suites. These test engineers work within an AGILE framework across nine SCRUM teams, ensuring functional deliverables meet our required quality 'Definitions of Done'.
- Coordination of a specialist performance test sub-group (JMeter + Gatling) with the Product Architecture group, which has improved data throughput benchmark metrics by 40% in 2025.
- Interfacing closely with Product Development and Product Management teams in Ireland, UK, and Poland, especially in the area of non-functional test requirement considerations in quarterly Product planning.

Customer Engineering Manager June 2006 – Present

Manager of the SymphonyAI Customer Engineering team based in Dublin. This software engineering team is responsible for client driven custom extensions to the core financial crime product stack.

The role involves;

- Management of a geographically dispersed team of 10+ Java engineers, including resource prioritisation and staff development.
- Supervision of engineering delivery for 30+ engagements per year with Profession Services division (projects vary in scale).
- Alignment with Product Management leadership to ensure that custom development is harvested into a bi-annual Product release process.

Company name – AIG Europe

IT Portfolio Manager April 2004 – May 2006 (2 Years)

I managed the delivery of a new general insurance system into the Dutch, Austrian, Swiss and Russian AIG offices. Each project had a budget of 1M+ USD, and the team consisted of 12+ IT specialists.

Company name – VISION Consulting

IT Consultant October 1996 – March 2004 (8 Years)

Managing teams of software engineers on separate client sites.

PROFESSIONAL/TECHNICAL SKILLS

Test Automation + Engineering Excellence: Java Selenium/Selenide Automation, Automation Framework Enhancement, Test Automation Best-Practice Development, GenAI-led Test Automation, AI Agentic Testing.

Tools: IntelliJ + GitHub CoPilit, Visual Studio Code + Roo Code (Playwright PoCs), GitHub, Jenkins, JIRA/Zephyr. Python (development of test case and test data generation).

Technical Leadership + Strategic Support: QA Software Chapter Management, Product Software Engineering Quality Strategy, AI Adoption, Agile Delivery, CTO PMO and Revenue Support..

Quality Metrics + Reporting: QA Metric Dashboards, KPI Reporting, PowerBI + Tableau Visualisation.

Cloud + Platform Knowledge: AWS/Azure Expertise, Cloud-based Testing.